

CREATING DEPTH

All paintings, regardless of subject matter, rely on the use of warm and cool colors to create a sense of depth. By understanding how distance and atmosphere change colors and tones, you can control the sense of depth in your paintings.



The initial sketch has the warm and cool colors accurately placed, but it lacks a sense of depth because the colors are all of the same intensity.



The final painting has the colors carefully positioned and decreasing in intensity toward the horizon, so has a sense of depth.



The use of warm and cool colors on the face helps to make it look three-dimensional.

The warm color of the vest comes forward to give bulk to the figure.

Warm tones in the jacket complement the skin tones.

In this portrait colors have been chosen from both the warm and cool palette. The vest, for example, is a warm yellow, but the background yellows are cool. It is this careful use of color that creates the sense of depth.